

PINK REPORT

Given NCCN lists rituximab maintenance as **optional** after response to single-agent rituximab, and the best available evidence suggests **PFS may improve without a demonstrated OS benefit**, it is **appropriate to stop rituximab after CR and proceed with active surveillance** in this 82-year-old with comorbidities—while acknowledging maintenance remains reasonable if the patient prioritizes longer time-to-progression despite uncertain survival benefit. (NCCN; Rossi)

This table summarizes available evidence on **rituximab maintenance after response to rituximab-based therapy in marginal zone lymphoma (including splenic MZL)**, organized from highest to lowest level of rigor; guideline and synthesized evidence are highlighted in green, while observational data appear in red. (NCCN; Rossi; Oh; Kalpadakis; Rule)

References supporting summary ordered by strength of evidence:

Rank	Level of Evidence	Study Title	Authors	Journal (Year)	Notes
 1	Guideline	<i>B-Cell Lymphomas</i>	National Comprehensive Cancer Network (NCCN)	NCCN Guidelines (Updated 2025-12-22)	Lists rituximab maintenance 375 mg/m² q8–12 weeks for up to 2 years as “optional” extended therapy after CR/PR to single-agent rituximab; active surveillance is acceptable . Narrative expert review (not a formal meta-analysis) ; notes maintenance rituximab in MZL is controversial with no clear survival benefit demonstrated.
 2	Clinical Trial Meta-analysis	<i>Marginal-Zone Lymphomas</i>	Rossi D, Bertoni F, Zucca E	NEJM (2022)	In relapsed/refractory indolent NHL, extended maintenance beyond standard duration did not provide sufficient evidence to support prolongation past ~2 years . (Not
  3	Phase 3 (P3) Trial	<i>MabCute: Prolonged Maintenance With Subcutaneous Rituximab in Relapsed/Refractory Indolent NHL</i>	Rule S, Barreto WG, Briones J, et al.	Haematologica (2022)	

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4	Phase 2 (P2) Trial	<i>R-CVP Followed by Rituximab Maintenance for Advanced MZL (CISL Study)</i>	Oh SY, Kim WS, Kim JS, et al.	Cancer Communications (2019)	MZL-specific; informs “don’t extend indefinitely.”) Single-arm P2: reported favorable 3-year PFS/OS with maintenance and tolerability; regimen was R-CVP induction , so applicability to rituximab-only induction is indirect.
5	Phase 1 (P1) Trial				
6	Large Cohort Study				
7	Cohort Study	<i>Maintenance rituximab in splenic marginal zone lymphoma (reported retrospective series)</i>	Kalpadakis C, Pangalis GA, Angelopoulou MK, Sachanas S, Vassilakopoulou TP	Best Practice & Research: Clinical Haematology (2018)	Cites retrospective SMZL experience where maintenance was associated with improved CR rates and PFS, without OS difference ; observational design → confounding/selection bias likely.
8	Animal Model				